

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-8 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

Egg waffles: the history of Hong Kong's favourite street snack

- 1 [1] Egg waffles, eggettes, egg puffs, gai daan jai, bubble waffles – these are just some of the names for this quintessential Hong Kong street snack. A childhood staple for most locals, egg waffles have seen a surge in popularity around the world. A chain in the city has even been given the Michelin Guide's thumbs up of approval. Compared to the star treatment it has been getting, the snack actually has more humble beginnings.
- 5 [2] The egg waffle first appeared in the city's streets in the 1950s as a way to use broken eggs that could not be sold. Instead of tossing them out, these eggs were mixed into a batter with flour, sugar and evaporated milk. It was poured into a waffle iron and cooked over a charcoal flame. To achieve the waffles' signature look, the mould was flipped as soon as the batter was poured in. The result was a delicious waffle that was crispy on the outside and soft on the inside.
- 10 [3] The enterprising shopkeepers who invented the snack also ensured it was affordable for the masses. The waffle iron created a mass of miniature eggs which could be easily broken apart and bought as individual bubbles. This snack proved to be so popular that it was soon sold on nearly every street corner in Hong Kong.
- [4] These days, most vendors use an electric waffle machine instead of the traditional iron. But the ingredients have not changed much over the years. The batter is usually a mixture of flour, baking powder, custard powder,
- 15 eggs, sugar and milk. Fillings can range from the classic to the funky – such as chocolate chips, pork floss, black sesame and salted egg yolk.
- [5] In terms of its nutritional value, one egg waffle typically has about 12 grams of fat and 400 calories. To put this in perspective, an egg waffle contains as many calories as one and a half slices of pizza. Thus, it is best to eat them as an occasional treat and to share them with your friends or family.
- 20 [6] But if you happen to have an electric waffle machine tucked away in your kitchen, why not put your cooking skills to the test? Try this recipe for a gai daan jai that has less fat and sugar than what you might find on the streets.

[7] Ingredients (serves 2)

For the dry ingredients, you will need:

- 25 - ¾ cup spelt flour
- 1 tablespoon custard powder
- 1½ teaspoon baking powder

For the wet ingredients, you will need:

- 30 - ¾ cup cold milk
- 2 large eggs
- ¼ cup monk fruit blend sweetener
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- 50 grams salted butter, melted

[8] You will also need some vegetable oil spray.

35 [9] Directions

1. Combine all the dry ingredients, and set them aside.
2. Add all the wet ingredients to a blender. Blend until smooth.
3. Add the dry ingredients to the blended wet ingredients. Then, blend the mixture until you can no longer see any bits of flour. It is alright if the mixture is a bit lumpy.
40 4. Cover the batter with cling film, and place it in the fridge for 30 minutes.
5. Preheat the waffle machine to a medium heat setting. Grease it with vegetable oil spray.
6. Pour about half of the batter into one side of the waffle iron. Close the mould, and hold the handle firmly to prevent the batter from leaking. Then, flip the closed mould so the egg batter fills the other side evenly.
7. Cook for about 4 to 5 minutes or until both sides are golden brown.
45 8. Remove the waffle carefully, and fold it gently to form a cone shape. Place your waffles on a rack – they will become crisp as they cool.

[10] Enjoy your home-made gai daan jai!

Read Passage Two and answer questions 9-14 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage Two:

Why emojis on social media say what words can't

- 1 [1] "I can't wait to see you tomorrow! 😊". While this seems like any other message we might send to a close friend, there is much more than meets "the face with heart eyes".
- [2] To find out what some of our most-used emoticons might say about us, we spoke to psychologist Leah Selakovic, who shared all about how emojis changed the way we communicate. Selakovic works at SACAC
- 5 Counselling, a mental health clinic in Singapore. She said the most frequently used emoticons tended to be the ones involving human faces.
- [3] This was reflected in an annual study by Facemoji Keyboard – an app developed by Chinese tech company Baidu. Based on Facemoji's findings, the "face with tears of joy" 😂 topped the ranks as the most-used emoji six years in a row.
- 10 [4] "That's not at all surprising once you understand how these different smiley faces work," the psychologist explained. "It can sometimes be difficult to interpret the tone of a message, and emojis serve to clarify that." She added that when the sender's message was clear, there was a higher chance of getting the intended emotional response. Even when a text message was straightforward, emojis could effectively emphasise a point or emotion. Selakovic illustrated this by pointing out the "thumbs up" 👍 emoji, which could, for example, strengthen the
- 15 positive tone of a simple "Congratulations!" text.
- [5] This was how emojis changed our speech patterns and communication, she said. As a matter of fact, the typical "LOL" and "hahaha" responses have been increasingly replaced with their emoji counterparts – "rolling on the floor laughing" 🤣 and "face with tears of joy" 😂. This is because these images are a much more accurate depiction of the facial expressions we make.
- 20 [6] "Our brains ... create a link between emojis and the emotions they are meant to represent. These images are a powerful form of non-verbal communication," Selakovic said. "This means our brains process them as emotional communication rather than words." Thus, a lot of meaning could be packed inside these tiny icons, and they might even reveal certain aspects of our personalities.
- [7] Researchers at the University of Rochester published a study in 2018 that examined the relationship between
- 25 emoji usage and personality on Twitter. It found that individuals who scored higher in conscientiousness (a personality trait of being careful or diligent) used fewer negative emojis such as "loudly crying face" 😭 or "weary face" 😞. Rather, they tended to express themselves with more upbeat emojis like "thumbs up" 👍 and "smiley face" 😊. Individuals who scored higher on agreeableness often used heart-shaped emojis and kissing emojis – images that convey feelings of empathy. In its analysis, the study offered the explanation that emojis
- 30 were better than words when conveying empathy.
- [8] Separately, Selakovic pointed to a 2017 study on use of emojis in the workplace. It found that extroverts tended to use more emojis to express themselves. But she said more research was needed to understand if those with certain personality traits used specific icons more often. The psychologist added that researchers were split on whether emojis were harming or benefiting how teens communicated. An emoji's ability to simplify words
- 35 and feelings could appeal to young people who were still finding their voice since it might give them another means to express themselves.
- [9] But this could come at a cost. "Human emotions are complex," she cautioned. "There is a concern that an over-reliance on simplified forms of expression could impair an individual's capacity for emotional expression later in life."
- 40 [10] Nonetheless, Selakovic said emojis could give us insight into today's internet culture and the emotions we valued on social media. Whether we use a heart or the "face with tears of joy" 😂 emoji, the feelings we yearn for in real life are translated into how we interact with others online.

END OF READING PASSAGES



FORM 2

GENERAL ENGLISH

QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 3

Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.

Passage One (15 marks)

1. Find a word in paragraph 1 that has a similar meaning to 'typical'.

2. Find a word in paragraph 1 that is opposite in meaning to 'decline'.

3. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given.

(3 marks)

- | | T | F | NG |
|---|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| (i) The egg waffle first appeared in the city in the 1950s as an affordable treat. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (ii) The egg puffs became popular among locals after a recommendation made by the Michelin Guide. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (iii) Modern bubble waffles taste better than traditional ones. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
4. You should not consume a whole egg waffle by yourself because...
- | | | | | |
|---|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| A. egg waffles are for treating friends and family. | | | | |
| B. egg waffles are eaten on special occasions. | | | | |
| C. egg waffles are quite high in fat and calories for a snack. | A | B | C | D |
| D. an egg waffle is the size of one and a half slices of pizza. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

5. What does '(serves 2)' in line 23 mean?

6. Below is a table summarising the ingredients of traditional and healthier home-made egg waffles. Complete all the boxes in the table by writing 'Y' for yes or 'N' for no. (4 marks)

Ingredients	Traditional egg waffles	Healthier home-made egg waffles
(i) flour		
(ii) baking powder		
(iii) butter		
(iv) sugar		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

7. Arrange the events in chronological order by writing the letters in the spaces below. The first event should be on the left, and the last event on the right.

- A. Mix dry and wet ingredients together.
- B. Heat up and grease the egg waffle iron.
- C. Pour in about half of the batter and rotate the mould.
- D. Blend the wet ingredients.
- E. Leave the waffles on a rack once they are golden brown.
- F. Refrigerate the batter for half an hour.

_____ > _____ > _____ > _____ > _____ > _____

8. Complete the following food review by writing **ONE** word taken from paragraph 9 in each blank below. Your answers must be grammatically correct. (3 marks)

Located in North Point, this Michelin-recommended egg waffle shop has mastered the perfect texture of gai daan jai. Its egg waffles are deliciously (i) _____ on the outside and satisfyingly chewy on the inside. Using a family recipe, I wonder what secret (ii) _____ the vendor used in the batter. Although I had to queue for 20 (iii) _____, it was definitely worth it!

Passage Two (15 marks)

9. What does 'This' in line 7 refer to?

10. According to paragraph 4, what are the two functions of using emojis in a message? (2 marks)

11. Find a word in paragraphs 5-7 which matches each of the definitions below. (4 marks)

- (i) things that have the same purpose or function as others in a different place or organisation _____
- (ii) not relating to the use of words _____
- (iii) full of hope, happiness, and good feelings _____
- (iv) the ability to imagine what it must be like to be in someone's situation _____

12. What is Selakovic's attitude towards the 2017 study on the relationship between specific emoji usage and personality?

- A. Positive
- B. Uncertain
- C. Encouraging
- D. Disapproving

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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13. Based on the 2018 study done by researchers at the University of Rochester, which of the emojis are each of the following groups most likely to use? (3 marks)

Those who score higher on being hardworking



Those who score higher on being pleasant



14. Researchers have given arguments for and against the use of emojis by teenagers. Complete the summary in the table below. Use only **ONE** word from paragraphs 8-9 for each blank. You may adjust the forms of the words to make them grammatically correct. (4 marks)

Main argument for	Main argument against
As these tiny icons on the screens provide another outlet for emotional (i) _____, it is (ii) _____ for teens who are still finding their voice.	Teenagers might be (iii) _____ on the simplified forms of expression emojis offer, and not be able to express their (iv) _____ as well as later in life.

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

Earlier this year, long before his classmates voted against his proposal, Brian (1) (make) up his mind to represent his class and perform ballet in the school talent show.

Brian's classmates objected. "Most ballet dancers are girls. If Brian does ballet, he (2) (laugh) at by the other students."

Brian (3) (study) ballet since he was 3 years old. He first attended dance lessons for fun. However, his quick mastery of ballet jumps soon (4) (catch) the attention of his teacher. After (5) (discover) his natural talent and passion for ballet, Brian's parents hired a professional coach to offer proper training to their son . Since then, his skills have improved dramatically and he (6) (win) several local competitions.

"I understand your worries. I (7) (not be) afraid of being teased. In fact, I am proud of being a ballet dancer. I hope you will understand the beauty of ballet." The disapproval of his classmates did not shatter his dream of (8) (do) ballet in the talent show. Brian drew posters and gave presentations, patiently explaining to his classmates the choreography, costumes, scenic design and music involved in his performance. (9) (move) by his determination and hard work, Brian's classmates finally gave the go-ahead for the ballet performance. "We look forward to (10) (see) you shine in the talent show." They all smiled broadly.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the passage. You may need to change the form of some words. Each word should only be used **once**.

brighten	reassemble	mediocre	notable	agile
resemble	sympathy	hardships	dampen	marginally

'Grandma, can you tell me about my great grandfather?'

'Sure, my dear. Your great grandfather Eric was a loving father and a prominent businessman. Despite the considerable (1) he endured at an early age, he never gave up. No string of defeats could (2) his spirit.'

'Does he have a nickname like I do?'

'Yes, Lily. He was the one and only "Mr. Squid". Do you know how he got his name?'

'Let me guess. Was he a keen swimmer? Was he nimble?'

'Good guess. Speaking of (3), he was very deft at handling awkward and unexpected situations. He got his nickname from being one of the early pioneers in importing squid from New Zealand to China. In his heyday, he sold as many squid as all the other companies in the country put together.'

'That's extraordinary! Does my mother (4) my great grandfather in any way?'

'Yes, in many ways, most (5), her grit. She inherited the urge to take on challenges from him and followed in his footsteps to become a successful businesswoman.'

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

C. Parts of Speech (5 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

1. My school's football team never takes their after school training seriously. My classmates said their defeat in the latest inter-school match was totally (predict).
2. Due to increasing demand for medical services and insufficient health care resources, some sick people are being denied (accessible) to proper medical care.
3. This book is truly remarkable. It (influence) me profoundly when I was given it by my parents 5 years ago.
4. Her dream is to make a (document) series about local paralympic athletes like Yu Chui Yee and Leung Yuk-wing, focusing on their struggles and achievements.
5. 'Stop smiling (mystery)! Tell me what is going on!' my little brother yelled.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

D. Articles (5 marks)

Complete the following passages by inserting the most appropriate article ('a', 'an', 'the' or an 'X' where no article is needed) in each of the blanks.

Mr Brain

Takuya Kimura plays the role of Tsukumo Ryusuke, a neuroscientist, in the Japanese drama *Mr Brain*. His brain was damaged in an accident. Since (1) accident, the right hemisphere of his brain has developed rapidly. As (2) result, his analytical powers become far more advanced than those of (3) ordinary people. He then uses his new-found abilities to crack difficult criminal cases.

Shutter Island

Teddy Daniels (Leonardo DiCaprio) is supposedly from (4) United States Marshals Service. He is investigating the disappearance of a murderer from Shutter Island, (5) island prison that houses the criminally insane. While investigating the case, he starts to develop some psychiatric problems himself. Is Teddy going crazy, or are the island's suspicious doctors and wardens just making him think he is?

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

E. Reported Speech (10 marks)

Using a suitable reporting verb form from the boxes in the appropriate form, change the following direct speech into reported speech. You may use each verb **ONCE** only.

accuse	demand	remind	offer	suggest
--------	--------	--------	-------	---------

1. 'Remember to stay calm when there is a fire drill,' the teacher said to the students.

2. 'I saw you cheat in the Maths test yesterday,' Chloe said to John.

3. 'Would you like me to buy you a sandwich tomorrow?' Joe asked Karen.

4. 'Show me your driving licence now,' the policeman said to me.

5. 'Shall we go to Disneyland next weekend?' Walter asked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Tokyo Olympics: strangely – or sensibly – specific rules for athletes

As the world's best athletes try to (1) to Olympic glory, what you might not see are a host of rules they have to reckon with to ensure they can play on competition day. Here is a look at some of the weird and wonderful rules of Olympics competition.

Fencing

Fencers have traditionally worn white clothing (2) touches were recorded on the surface of their opponent's clothing through ink-soaked cotton on weapon tips. Now, with electronic scoring, fencers are permitted to wear clothing of any colour (3) black.

Clothing, however, must be made entirely (4) material that is able to withstand a significant amount of force. This rule became (5) strict after the 1982 World Championships when Russian fencer Vladimir Smirnov died when his opponent's broken blade pierced his brain through his mask. Jackets, under-plastrons, breeches and trousers must be able to resist 800 Newtons of pressure (nearly 82kg of force), while the bib of the mask must be able to resist 1,600 Newtons (163kg of force).

Gymnastics

It's not necessary for gymnasts to compete barefoot in gymnastics. The International Gymnastics Federation allows gymnasts to perform in socks, and some (6) for it to help them with their turns and prevent sweating.

They can also wear nail polish, but mostly neutral colours to avoid (7) distraction for judges. US gymnast Simone Biles and Sunisa Lee have become (8) for their nail-art during competition, with Lee winning her gold medal while wearing a long set of acrylic nails featuring a design with the Olympic rings.

Track and Field

Running barefoot or with only one shoe in a competition sounds like a crazy idea but it's actually allowed by the International Association of Athletics Federation. Shoes provide athletes with protection and (9) to the feet and a firm grip on the (10). However, they cannot be constructed to give athletes any unfair advantage.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

1. A. fight their way B. fix their way C. change their ways D. give way	2. A. because of B. due to C. because D. as a result of	3. A. apart B. except C. beside D. exclude
4. A. in B. by C. of D. for	5. A. less B. much C. as D. more	6. A. choose B. opt C. prefer D. decide
7. A. create B. to create C. creating D. creates	8. A. known B. notoriety C. celebrate D. asked	9. A. stable B. stability C. stabilise D. stabilising
10. A. trail B. road C. aisle D. track		

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

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G. Participles (10 marks)

Complete the following text using the correct present or past participle forms of the verbs in brackets.

Dear Douglas,

I have finally collected all the birthday gifts from the post office despite the snow. You know what? Your gift is the best! Thank you! I was so (1) (excite) when I saw the brand name on the wrapping paper. Their scented candles are phenomenal. They not only smell (2) (amaze), but also look very chic. They do have stores in Japan but their products, all (3) (produce) in France, are way more expensive here. They are sold at an insane 50% markup. Anyway, you made my day!

Wait! How can I not mention your DIY birthday card! I was very (4) (impress). To be honest, I have kept every single of them since Primary 1. It is always so (5) (satisfy) to read your neat handwriting and admire your beautiful drawings. Don't worry. I won't throw any of the cards away. You know, pictures (6) (paint) by famous artists usually sell for millions of dollars these days. I have faith in you! I am going to keep yours as I'm sure your artworks will be displayed in renowned museums all around the world one day!

One funny thing is that my parents, (7) (know) I love reading, sent me 12 books! Can you imagine how heavy the parcel was? Imagine me carrying 20 pounds of books and walking 3 km home myself. Let's not forget my little sister Rosy. She sent me a birthday video and sang a song (8) (write) by her friend. It is not the best song I have ever heard, but it was very (9) (touch).

By the way, I believe you should have received the souvenir I bought from Mount Fuji by now. SURPRISE! A can of Mount Fuji air. I know it sounds silly to get you an 'empty' can - even the cashier looked (10) (astonish) when I paid for it - but I hope you like it!

Cheers,
Robert

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

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H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

a	When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other
b	by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts.
c	In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓
d	mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou.

1 Our brain is like a computer, and governs every processes in our body. It is divided into a left and right
2 hemisphere. The left hemisphere controls the right side of our body, and the right hemisphere controls
3 the left side of our body. Two hemispheres also govern different behaviours. The left hemisphere
4 governs logical abilities, likes maths and language skills. The right hemisphere governs creative
5 abilities, like imagination and musical ability. The two hemispheres work together help us
6 understand, reason and analysing the world around us.

7 The size of the brain alone is not proportional on intelligence. A person's intelligence quotient (IQ) can
8 be determine using various methods, but each method will produce different results. Moreover, different
9 people have different level of education, so it is very hard to accurately determine someone's IQ accurately.
10 However, the size of particularly areas of the brain can reflect specific aspects of IQ.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.